

film making and TV production. The courses available provide an overview of the film and television production process, where you can learn the arts and aesthetics of video production. The limited number of seats at such institutes means fierce competition. One of the advantages of joining such an institute is that you can get an internship, or assist with a project, which can be beneficial during or after the academic schedule. The basic requirement to gain admission into these institutes is a graduate degree; the good news is that it could be in any field.

The post-production process is exciting as well as challenging. It involves the correction of or improvement upon scene mistakes, and visual manipulation as well as enhancement of filmed shots. Pre-visualised concepts can be presented on the screen with the help of Computer Generated Imagery (CGI) or what is commonly called Visual Effects (Vfx). Professionals and artists from the animation field are very much in demand in post-production.

"This field is very broad, and the skill sets can be divided into two broad parts—Technical and Arts. A person should possess artistic grace as well as technical knowledge, besides other basic skills—drawing and sketching, visualising, painting, and storyboarding," says Prof Shashikant Pandey, Head of Department—Post Production at the Asian Academy of Film and Television, Noida (an institute that gives education and training in the art and craft of film and television production).

Aspirants planning to take up post-production as a career should begin grooming basic skills such as drawing, modelling, and visualising, and also acquire knowledge about the various tools and technologies used in post-production. Work hours are never fixed in this field, especially with news channels, which work round the clock. Those not willing to work at odd hours—or even, sometimes, all day—need to do some serious re-thinking about the field they're getting into!

"No specific qualification is required for entering this field. However, this is a service



**The Indian entertainment industry is slowly and gradually pacing up towards using cutting-edge technologies for better output"**

**Raman Madan**  
Regional manager,  
Animation and Desktop  
Video  
South East Asia & India  
AutoDesk

### Get The Training

**S**ome prominent institutes providing education and training on film and television production:

Film and Television Institute of India, Pune  
National Institute of Design, Ahmedabad  
Whistling Woods International, Mumbai  
Asian Academy of Film and Television, Noida  
Film and Television Institute of Tamil Nadu, Chennai  
Xavier's Institute of Communication, Mumbai  
Satyajit Ray Film & Television Institute, Kolkata  
Foundation Institute of Learning Media, Delhi  
Symbiosis Institute of Mass Communication, Pune  
L.V. Prasad Film & TV Academy, Chennai

sector, and the industry looks at hands-on experience, training received, and projects worked upon. Technical and artistic proficiency is only achieved after years of experience and positive attitude. Patience is a necessary virtue for any fresher joining the industry," says Naresh Malik, CEO, Pixion—a post-production house.

### Going Digital

Post-production has now been widely impacted by the digital revolution. Software and conversion techniques are incorporated as and when they are available, and are now being adopted in India in the entertainment industry. Education and training upon software that have the features used in post-production can be availed from private institutions.

These institutions include such names as Arena Multimedia, Maya Academy for Advanced Cinematics, Zee Institute of Media Arts, and Real Image Media Technologies Pvt Ltd, to name a few. These provide the latest career, professional, and short-term courses on editing, animation, graphics design, compositing, and Vfx. India has a large number of big, medium, and small private education and training Institutes, but only a few of them are certified by the multinational entities—Autodesk, Avid, Apple, Pinnacle, Adobe, Edius et al—who provide a wide range of software for specific purposes in post-production.

"The biggest problem in India is the lack of trained artists. Few students today are aware of the opportunities in this field, and that's why a lot of artists fumble when it comes to this as a career. But the trend is changing rapidly: some training institutes are doing a good job by imparting software training and education. At Prime Focus, we train our own crew members to make them better artists and provide a growth path for them," says Merzin Tavaría, creative director—Prime Focus Ltd (a post-production and Vfx service house).

Software makers are now moving towards providing education and training courses on the products they supply, which are accepted as standards in the industry for particular tasks such as editing, compositing, finishing etc. Their basic goal is to provide software education and training to meet the demands and requirements of the media and entertainment industry.

### Post-production Software Used By Professionals

#### Visual Effects

- ❑ Autodesk Lustre (Color Grading)
- ❑ Autodesk Maya, 3ds Max (animation)
- ❑ Mental Ray, VIZ
- ❑ Adobe AfterEffects
- ❑ Adobe Photoshop
- ❑ Autodesk Flame
- ❑ Character Studio
- ❑ Softimage XSI
- ❑ Avid 3D

#### Digital Compositing Softwares

- ❑ Autodesk Inferno, Flame, Fire and Combustion systems
- ❑ Adobe AfterEffects (Windows)
- ❑ Eyeon Digital Fusion/Fusion 5
- ❑ D2's Nuke

#### Editing and Finishing

- ❑ Adobe Premiere (Windows)
- ❑ Autodesk Smoke and Fire
- ❑ Avid Xpress Pro (Windows and Mac)
- ❑ Avid Media Composer (Windows)
- ❑ Avid Liquid (Windows)
- ❑ Avid Symphony Nitris (Windows)
- ❑ Avid DS Nitris (Microsoft Windows)
- ❑ Cinelerra (Linux)
- ❑ EditStudio Pro (Windows)
- ❑ Final Cut Pro (Mac OS X)
- ❑ Kino (Linux)
- ❑ Leitch's DPS Velocity (Windows)
- ❑ Magix Movie Edit Pro (Windows)
- ❑ Magix Video Deluxe (Windows)
- ❑ Pinnacle Studio (Windows)
- ❑ Ulead Video Studio (Windows)